

How do the French relate to artificial intelligence?

Foreword

According to the Baromètre du numérique 2024 [<https://labo.societenumerique.gouv.fr/fr/articles/barom%C3%A8tre-du-num%C3%A9rique-2024-les-principaux-r%C3%A9sultats/>] , published on March 17, 2025, the use of artificial intelligence (AI) tools has risen sharply in one year among the French population: 33% of French people have already used them in 2024, compared with 20% in 2023. This strong progression is accompanied by a high level of mistrust of these artificial intelligence tools for the majority of the population, although this mistrust is declining as personal use of these tools increases. Moreover, AI use is influenced by gender and age.

Growing use of AI

Uses of artificial intelligence in the context of private life dominate (26%, +10 points in one year), slightly outstripping those linked to professional life (22%, also +10 points over the same period).

Référence : 1

Utilisation personnelle des outils d'intelligence artificielle

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Gender and age are factors that influence the use of AI.

Men use artificial intelligence tools more than women, both in their private and professional lives.

By 2024, 25% of men will be using them professionally, compared with 20% of women, and 30% of men will be using them in their private lives, compared with 22% of women.

This gender gap remains similar to that observed in 2023.

Utilisation personnelle des outils d'IA dans le cadre de la vie professionnelle ou des études (par genre)

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Utilisation personnelle des outils d'IA dans le cadre de la vie privée (par genre)

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To shed some light on these findings, the authors of the survey mention two recent studies (see below) which indicate that, even when working in the same jobs, men are more likely to turn to artificial intelligence and ChatGPT than women. " *According to these studies, women's lack of self-confidence could be partly responsible for this situation: women who don't use artificial intelligence more often than men indicate their need for training to use this new technology.*"

Références : 23

69% of 18-24 year-olds have already used AI

As in 2023, 18-24 year-olds are the age group that most frequently uses artificial intelligence tools in their professional lives or as part of their studies. Thus, 69% of them have already used AI in this context, compared with 41% of 25-39 year-olds. What's more, 58% of 18-24 year-olds use AI in their private lives, compared to 41% of 25-39 year-olds.

These generational gaps were already present in 2023, in similar proportions.

Utilisation personnelle des outils d'intelligence artificielle selon la tranche d'âge

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The majority of French people do not trust artificial intelligence

56% of French people have no confidence in artificial intelligence, with 21% expressing strong distrust. It should be noted that distrust of artificial intelligence decreases with personal use.

Degré de confiance dans l'intelligence artificielle

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Respondents who have already integrated artificial intelligence into their professional lives, studies or daily lives are more confident overall (74%) than those who have not yet used it (26%). *"Without being able to determine with any certainty the direction of the correlation: have those most open to AI been more inclined to adopt it? Or is it the use of AI that reinforces confidence in this technology?"* comment the survey's authors.

Degré de confiance dans l'intelligence artificielle selon l'adoption de l'intelligence artificielle

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More users, men tend to trust artificial intelligence more than women: 45% of men declare themselves confident, compared to 38% of women, a gap of 7 points. Moreover, distrust of artificial intelligence increases with age. Older people are more skeptical than younger ones: 70% of those aged 70 and over express distrust, compared with only 38% of 18-24 year-olds.

AI is mostly perceived as a threat in the employment and artistic creation sectors

Opinions on the impact of AI on the environment and sustainable development remain divided, with no clear consensus (48% see it as a threat, 48% as an opportunity). Finally, in the field of education and training in 2024, AI is slightly more often perceived as an opportunity (50%), although a significant number of respondents (47%) still see it as a threat.

Perception des risques ou opportunités représentés par l'usage de l'IA

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In all the fields assessed, men are more likely than women to perceive artificial intelligence as an opportunity rather than a threat. This difference is particularly noticeable in the environment sector, where 53% of men see AI as an opportunity, compared to 43% of women. Similarly, men are more likely than women to see AI as an

opportunity in education and training (55% of men versus 46% of women).

Younger generations are clearly more optimistic than their elders about the impact of artificial intelligence. Young people are consistently among the respondents who most frequently perceive AI as an opportunity, across all fields.

Sources

- 1. Digital Barometer 2024

[<https://labo.societenumerique.gouv.fr/fr/articles/barom%C3%A8tre-du-num%C3%A9rique-2024-les-principaux-r%C3%A9sultats/>]

- 2. Humlum, A., & Vestergaard, E. (2024). The Adoption of ChatGPT. SSRN Electronic Journal

[<https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4807516>]

- 3. Carvajal, D., Franco, C., & Isaksson, S. (2024). Will Artificial Intelligence Get in the Way of Achieving Gender Equality? SSRN Electronic Journal.

[<https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4759218>]

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